THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE TEMPLATE

The Deliberate Week

A one-page way to build your week around what comes first, with AI carrying the load, wherever in the world you work from.

Put the first things first, and let the rest fit around them.

Most weeks are built backwards.

We fill the week with work and hope there is something left for the rest. Faith, family, health, rest. Whatever comes first for you gets the leftovers.

If you work for yourself, or remotely, the week is yours to shape, and that is both the gift and the trap. Nobody else will protect the things that matter, so you have to place them first and build the work around them.

Backwards

Work expands to fill every gap, and the important things are squeezed into what is left.

Deliberate

The important things are placed first. Work gets the hours that remain, and AI shrinks how many it needs.

This template has four steps: name your first things, mark them in the week, hand the heavy work to AI, and review every Sunday. It takes about forty minutes once, and ten minutes a week after that.

A deliberate week is one you chose.

Name your first things.

Write down the three to five things that must be protected every week. Be specific, so you can tell if they happened.

FAITH	What does your practice need in a normal week? Write it in your own words.
FAMILY	The meals, the evenings, the days you refuse to give away. Who are they for?
BODY	Sleep, movement, food. The minimum that keeps you able to do the rest.
WORK	The one outcome that would make this week a good one.
YOURS	Whatever else belongs on the list. This is your week.

Nothing here is a rule about how you live. It is a place to write what you already know matters, so it stops being negotiable at 4pm on a Tuesday.

Place them, then plan the work.

1 **Mark the fixed points first.** Put your first things into the week as blocks and treat them as booked. Anything with a time that is not yours to move goes in before anything else.

2 **Count what is left.** That is your real work capacity. It is usually smaller than you hoped, and that is useful to know.

3 **Choose one outcome.** One result for the week, in one sentence, that would make it a good week of work.

BUILD MY WEEK

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These are the fixed points in my week that must not move: [list with
days and times]. These are my work commitments: [list]. The one
outcome that would make this week a good one is: [sentence]. Fit the
work around the fixed points. Show me what actually fits, what does
not, and what I should say no to or hand off. Do not move or shrink
anything on my fixed list.
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Let AI carry the load.

To fit more of what matters, you need fewer hours of the work that does not. Hand over the repeatable parts.

THE HAND-OFF

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Here are the jobs that fill my work hours: [list]. Tell me which ones you can do or draft for me, which ones only I can do, and which I can drop. For the ones you can do, tell me the exact input you need from me and how long it should take me to review. I want my review time to be as short as possible.
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THE DAILY START

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Here is my day: [fixed points, work]. Give me the three things that matter most, the one to do first, and what can wait. Keep it under 80 words. If I am overloading myself, say so.
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THE WORK-FROM-ANYWHERE CHECK

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I work remotely across time zones: [list]. Look at my meetings and deadlines and tell me where the time zone difference is eating into my fixed points, and suggest the smallest change that fixes it.
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The Sunday review.

Ten minutes before the week starts. It is how the week stays yours.

SUNDAY REVIEW

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Here is last week's plan and what actually happened: [paste]. Tell
me: which of my first things were protected and which were squeezed,
what pushed them out, one change that would protect them next week,
and one thing I can hand off. Then draft next week's plan around my
fixed points. Be direct and be kind.
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The one-page version

FIRST THINGS: _____

FIXED POINTS: _____

ONE OUTCOME: _____

HANDED TO AI: _____

DROPPED: _____

A planning aid, not advice. Adapt it to your own practice, family and work. Keep your own commitments first and change anything here that does not fit them.

Build the week around the first things. The rest will follow.